Advisor briefing — twofold plan (coding + publication)

For: Alex Gates
Context: Follow-up to **2026-03-13** conversation (`260313_Paper_directions_otter_ai.txt` in repo root).
Purpose: One-page-style status on the **two parallel lines**: (A) **525 / pipeline coding** and (B) **publication plan** (mechanism, venues, external data) — **without** assuming he has read the repo.

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1. What you asked for (from that conversation)

Theme	Your guidance (paraphrase)
Parallel tracks	Keep **writing / mechanism / venues** and **coding** moving; "a little of both" beats all-or-nothing.
UIC / pool consistency	Who is **consistently** in a strong pool (e.g., by UIC ranking on mean top-block in pool)? Year-to-year stability vs noise?
Senior raters	Do certain **senior raters** consistently host strong pools? → "Talent on **people** vs **organizations**."
LT OERs (longitudinal)	Richer path: same rater as **BN then BDE** commander over time (longitudinal senior-rater story).
Mechanism	**Articulate mechanism** underlying inverted-U; iterate with GPT; **reframe for different communities** (management science, OR/systems, business dynamics, etc.).
Literature ↔ mechanism	Two-stage loop: mechanism → literature → refine mechanism; **different bodies of literature** per community.
Venues	Likely **management-science / Contractor–type** visibility; not AER / core labor econ; interdisciplinary "big" journals need more results and/or more data.
External replication	Brainstorm **public** data where same pattern might appear; "magic number **three**" (Army + two) strengthens an interdisciplinary story; **articulation first**, then data search.
Pragmatic floor	Story can be built around **two figures** if needed; maximize what we have.

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2. Where we stand — Line A: Coding / 525 / 520

Your goal	Status	Notes
LT OERs integrated	**Done**	LT OERs are merged into the **snapshot** data used in 520 (same merge logic as other OER rows by officer × date).
Longitudinal senior-rater story (LT path)	**Unblocked at data layer**	LT rows exist on snapshots for analyses that **keep** them; the **Cox / promotion interval** build in Cell 10 **drops** LT rows by design — so 525-style or dedicated analyses should use snapshot-level or alternate cohort logic where LTs remain.
UIC × strong pools; consistency over time	**Planned + specified**	`525_plans.md` lays out UIC aggregation (rated officer company → battalion/brigade), pool-strength definition (mean TB in pool), and senior-rater-first design; notebook still **planning / not yet executed** as primary deliverable.
Senior rater × consistent strong pools	**Planned**	Same doc; parameterized for senior rater now, rater role extensible later.
Division / unit context for pools	**In progress**	`div_name` (and division-aware plots) depends on **DIVISION_CONFIG** path + columns flowing through 08 → 09 → 10 → 11; currently **troubleshooting in 520** (nearly resolved).
520 core result (inverted U, CIF, Cox)	**Stable baseline**	Run profile **17_1** and pipeline outputs remain the empirical backbone; refinements are **structure** (divisions, UIC, rater consistency) not replacement of core finding.

One-line summary for you: *Data integration ahead of the transcript (LT OERs on snapshots) is in place; 525 is fully planned on paper; execution is next once division/UIC plumbing in 520 is clean.*

3. Where we stand — Line B: Publication plan (non-coding)

Your goal	Status	Notes
Single publication roadmap	**Done**	`Publication_Plan.md` — intro, way ahead, mechanism section, venues, external data, links to artifacts.
Scholar GPT / replication landscape	**Done**	`replication_data_search.md` — datasets, papers, repos, keywords (summarized inside Publication Plan §4.1).
LLM brief for *datasets*	**Done**	`External_Data_Search_Brief.md` (paste into GPT for "where is public data like this?").
LLM brief for *mechanism × venues*	**Done**	`venues_and_mechanism_articulation_llm_brief.md` — project summary, community table (incl. **people analytics** as co-equal), copy-paste prompts, rollup table, **30-minute prompt workflow**.
Draft mechanism paragraphs in the plan	**Not yet**	`Publication_Plan.md` **§2** is still a placeholder; next step is to run the venue/mechanism brief in Scholar GPT and **paste short drafts** back into §2–§3.
Pick primary community + citations	**In progress**	Framing tools exist; **decision** waits on mechanism drafts + your feedback.

One-line summary for you: *The publication track is **documented and tool-ready** (plans + LLM briefs + replication memo); the **substance** of mechanism wording and venue choice is the next hour-generation task, not the scaffolding.*

4. Crosswalk: your asks → artifacts

Ask (transcript)	Artifact / location
UIC / consistent strong pools	`525_plans.md` §2.1, §5–8
Senior raters / people vs orgs	`525_plans.md` §2.2; `Publication_Plan.md` §1 item 3
LT OER longitudinal	Snapshot merge in 520; `525_plans.md` §2.2, §8 (Cell 10 caveat)
Mechanism + multi-community framing	`venues_and_mechanism_articulation_llm_brief.md`
External data / "three settings"	`External_Data_Search_Brief.md`, `replication_data_search.md`
Integrated roadmap	`Publication_Plan.md`, `525_plans.md`

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5. Suggested 60-second oral lead-in

> *"Since we talked, I've kept both threads moving. On the **data side**, LT OERs are now on the snapshot stack, so we can do the longitudinal senior-rater story where we don't rely on the Cox-only row set. I'm closing the loop on **division labels (`div_name`)** in 520 so pools and plots can be tied to org context. On **525**, the analysis plan is written end-to-end—UIC aggregation, senior rater consistency, longevity/path—we're ready to implement once division plumbing is stable.*
> *On the **paper side**, the publication plan is in one doc, we captured the Scholar GPT replication landscape, and I built two LLM briefs—one for finding public datasets, one for mechanism-by-venue articulation with a structured prompt workflow. What's **not** done yet is parking final mechanism paragraphs into the plan; that's the next writing block after one good Scholar GPT pass."*

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6. Questions / decisions that would help from you

1. **525 priority:** Start with **UIC consistency** vs **senior-rater consistency** vs **division-level** summary first?
2. **Longitudinal LT story:** Minimum viable output for a first meeting — **one figure** (e.g., rater fixed effects on pool mean TB over time) or **table** only?
3. **Venue:** Still comfortable with **management science / Contractor genre** as the *default* primary, with **people analytics** as an explicit parallel candidate, or do you want to **rank** them after skimming the LLM rollup once?
4. **External data:** Time horizon for a **second** public setting — thesis milestone only, or worth a **lightweight** replication attempt before defense?

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7. File index (repo: `current_documents/` unless noted)

File	Role
`advisor_brief_twofold_status.md`	**This briefing**
`525_plans.md`	525 coding / analysis plan
`Publication_Plan.md`	Publication + way-ahead hub
`replication_data_search.md`	Scholar GPT replication memo
`External_Data_Search_Brief.md`	LLM brief for dataset discovery
`venues_and_mechanism_articulation_llm_brief.md`	LLM brief for mechanism × venues
`260313_Paper_directions_otter_ai.txt`	**Root** — original transcript

Prepared as a briefing aid; numbers and "done" refer to state as described by the student for this meeting.